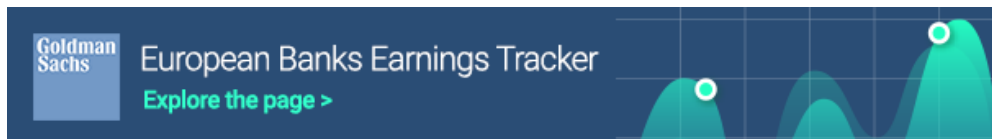


STANDARD CHARTERED (STAN.L/2888.HK)

Updating for 3Q25 results



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In short: 3Q25 was 14% ahead of consensus expectations at underlying PBT and 23% ahead at underlying earnings reflecting a 2% beat at NII, a 4% beat on non-NII, a 1% beat on opex, a 23% beat on credit costs and a 4pp lower than expected tax rate. Underlying ROTE was 13.4% in the quarter (cons. 10.1%) and CET1% came in at 14.2%. Guidance for total income and ROTE in FY25 has been increased: Standard Chartered now expects income growth to be towards the ‘upper-end’ of the 5-7% range this year (prev. ‘around the bottom end’) and see ROTE around 13% in 2025 and progressing thereafter (prev. approaching 13% in 2026 and progressing thereafter). Our EPS estimates increase by 3%/5%/4% across 2025/26/27E, principally reflecting the impact from a lower tax rate assumption, with our PBT estimates broadly unchanged.

Net interest income was -1% year-on-year at \$2,737mn in Q3, beating consensus by 2% primarily due to a better outcome on volumes. Deposit volumes rose 2% (\$11bn) quarter-on-quarter (FX adj.), driven by WRB term deposits and Transaction Services CASA inflows, while loan growth was modest at +1% (+\$1bn), mainly from WRB wealth lending mortgages. Pass-through rates (PTRs) remained within the target ranges of 60-75% for CIB and 35-50% for WRB, with an annualised impact from a 1p.p change in PTR of ~\$30mn. The company continue to expect NII to be down low single digit y/y in 2025; today’s better than expect Q3 print combined with unchanged consensus Q4 would imply -2% y/y for FY25. The recent increase in HIBOR has lifted the 2025 currency-weighted average rate from 331bps to 340bps today, however the anticipated average rate for FY26 implies a 55bps drop y/y vs 44bps previously. Net net, our NII forecasts rise by 1% p.a. over 2025-28E.

Non-NII was \$2,410mn in Q3, +13% y/y and 4% above consensus expectations. This was driven by a 16% beat in Wealth Solutions (structured products and managed investments) and a 10% beat in Global Banking (higher capital markets activity, good origination and distribution volumes). Revenue growth was more muted in Global Markets (+1% y/y) as continued growth in Flow revenues (+12% y/y) was offset by a

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lower contribution from Episodic items y/y; overall revenue in Global Markets (\$848mn) missed consensus expectations by 9%. Altogether, underlying operating income (\$5,147mn) beat consensus by \$166mn, as a \$65mn better than expected performance in NII (volume led) was coupled with the \$101mn beat vs consensus in non-NII. Our forecasts for non-NII decrease by 1% p.a. over 2025-28E, given the slightly lower than expected print in Global Markets income.

Operating expenses rose 4% year-on-year to \$2,953mn in Q3, 1% lower than consensus. This growth in operating expenses was mainly attributable to investment and business growth in CIB and Affluent within WRB (managers). The constant currency 2026 expense target of <\$12.3bn is reiterated; current FX puts it at ~\$12.4bn (company consensus \$12.355bn). Our underlying operating expense forecast sits at \$12.4bn in 2026E, with our forecasts broadly unchanged over 2025-28E.

Credit impairments were \$195mn, 23% below consensus. With WRB lower q/q (at \$107mn) due to a reduction in unsecured portfolios. CIB reported a \$64mn impairment inclusive of a \$25mn increase in overlays for HK CRE exposure. Loan loss rates are expected to normalise to 30-35bps, but continue to track below this range (24bps in Q3, 12bps in Q2, 25bps in Q1) We would therefore expect, all else equal, that consensus for FY25 impairments is likely to move lower. Our credit impairment forecasts decline by 1% over 2025-28E.

Capital and profitability: CET1% came in 10bps above expectations for Q3 at 14.2% with CET1 capital in line and RWAs \$1bn lower than expected. RWAs reduced by \$1bn q/q mainly driven by FX (-\$1.3bn) due to the stronger \$ and market risk RWAs (-\$1bn) more than offsetting a \$1.9bn increased result from asset growth and mix. The bank has confirmed that the op-risk RWA increase is now expected to be taken in Q4'25 rather than Q1'26; the size of the headwind is not confirmed but for comparison we note that it amounted to a c.\$3bn RWA increase in January 2025 (detailed in Q1'25 results). CET1% was c.10bps lower q/q, mainly due to the 50bps headwind from the \$1.3bn buyback announced in July; excluding the buyback effect, the 32bp increase in CET1% q/q includes c.50bps from earnings and a 10bp tailwind from FVOCI, FX and others offset by 30bps of AT1 and dividend accrual. Underlying net profit (post minorities and AT1) was \$1,208mn in Q3, 23% above consensus with the 14% underlying PBT beat boosted by a 4pp lower effective tax rate. Underlying ROTE was 13.4% in Q3, well ahead of consensus (10.1%). The Group now expect ROTE 'to be around 13% in 2025 and to progress thereafter' (previously 'to approach 13% in 2026 and to progress thereafter'). We model c.14% underlying ROTE in 2025/26E, increasing to c.15% by 2028E.

2025 and 2026 guidance:

2025 guidance points

- FY25 NII is expected to be down low-single-digit % y/y. Consensus currently models -2% y/y
- [NEW] FY25 Income growth expected to be towards the upper end of 5-7% range (previously 'around the bottom of the 5-7% range'). +7% y/y would imply \$20.65bn vs cons \$20.63bn.
- Positive income-to-cost jaws effect at constant currency and excluding notable items

2026 guidance points

- Currently tracking towards the upper end of the 5-7% 2023-2026 Income CAGR range
- Positive income-to-cost jaws effect at constant currency and excluding notable items
- Expenses to be below \$12.3bn (at constant currency), currently running at c.\$12.4bn due to FX

2025-26 guidance points

- Expect loan loss rates to normalise towards the historical through-the-cycle 30-35bps range
- Low-single-digit percentage growth in underlying loans and advances to customers and RWA
- Basel 3.1 day-1 impact expected to be close to neutral
- 13-14% CET1% target range
- Plan to return at least \$8bn to shareholders (2024-2026)
- Continue to increase full-year dividend per share over time
- [NEW] ROTE now expected to be around 13% in 2025 and to progress thereafter (previously to approach 13% in 2026 and to progress thereafter). Cons. 13.1% in 2025 and 12.7% in 2026.

Estimate changes, valuation and key risks

Our underlying EPS estimates increase by 3%/5%/4% in 2025/26/27E, with our PBT forecasts broadly unchanged but our effective tax rate forecasts slightly lower (we note management previously alluded to the tax rate falling to the high 20s %, aligned with our latest estimates). Our 12m-RIM derived price target increases 24% for 2888.HK (to HK\$168 from HK\$135) reflecting both our estimate changes and a revised assumption on the terminal ROE (from 8.5% to 13.0%).

Our 12m price target for STAN.L increases 28% (to 1,670p from 1,301p); this reflects both our estimate changes and a change in valuation methodology. We now adopt a P/E based valuation approach, consistent with the rest of our European Banks coverage; we value STAN.L at 8.5x P/E (with this target multiple broadly aligned with the historic discount STAN has traded at vs the wider sector over the past five years) applied to a 25% / 75% blend of 2026 / 2027 EPS. We maintain our Neutral ratings on STAN.L/2888.HK.

Downside risks include reversal/pause of positive jaws delivery, weaker EM sovereign credit, slower non-interest income growth on tighter mainland China capital controls. Upside risks include higher-than-expected balance sheet growth; more hedges built to reduce interest rate sensitivity; continued strong momentum in affluent business; elevated FX volatility in the market; better-than-expected cost reduction.

Exhibit 1: 3Q25 earnings review

\$mn, unless stated otherwise

\$mn, unless otherwise stated	Actual					3Q25E		Overview			
	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	GS	Cons	q/q	y/y	act/GS	Act/cons
Net interest income	2,769	2,977	2,796	2,703	2,737	2,656	2,672	1%	(1%)	3%	2%
Other income	2,135	1,857	2,594	2,806	2,410	2,385	2,309	(14%)	13%	1%	4%
- of which: notable items	12	25									
Operating income	4,904	4,834	5,390	5,509	5,147	5,041	4,981	(7%)	5%	2%	3%
Operating income ex notable items	4,892	4,809	5,390	5,509	5,147	5,041	4,981	(7%)	5%	2%	3%
Other operating expenses	(2,852)	(3,175)	(2,915)	(3,050)	(2,953)	(2,929)	(2,980)	(3%)	4%	1%	(1%)
UK bank levy	12	(102)			-	11					
Operating costs	(2,840)	(3,277)	(2,915)	(3,050)	(2,953)	(2,918)	(2,980)	(3%)	4%	1%	(1%)
PPOP	2,064	1,557	2,475	2,459	2,194	2,123	2,001	(11%)	6%	3%	10%
PPOP ex notable items	2,052	1,532	2,475	2,459	2,194	2,123	2,001	(11%)	7%	3%	10%
Loan impairments	(178)	(130)	(219)	(117)	(195)	(202)	(252)				
Other impairments	(92)	(353)	(6)	(3)	(20)	(25)	(19)				
Associates	13	(27)	27	64	6	13	11				
PBT - Underlying	1,807	1,047	2,277	2,403	1,985	1,909	1,742	(17%)	10%	4%	14%
PBT ex notable items - Underlying	1,795	1,022	2,277	2,403	1,985	1,909	1,742	(17%)	11%	4%	14%
PBT - Statutory	1,722	800	2,103	2,280	1,766	1,699	1,521	(23%)	3%	4%	16%
Tax/minority	(791)	(307)	(746)	(572)	(738)	(812)	(700)				
Attributable profit	931	493	1,357	1,708	1,028	888	821	(40%)	10%	16%	25%
Balance Sheet (\$bn) and ratios											
Net Loans	287	281	282	287	285	295	288	(1%)	(1%)	(3%)	(1%)
CET1 Ratio	14.2%	14.2%	13.8%	14.3%	14.2%	14.0%	14.1%	-19bp	-7bp	19bp	6bp
Risk-Weighted Assets	249	247	254	260	258	262	259	(1%)	4%	(1%)	(0%)

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Company-compiled consensus

Exhibit 2: Revenues by product line over time
 \$mn

Underlying Revenue (\$mn unless otherwise stated)	1Q23	2Q23	3Q23	4Q23	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	3Q25E		Overview		
												GSE	Cons	q/q	y/y	act/cons
Revenues by Product																
Transaction Services	1,561	1,608	1,654	1,647	1,603	1,593	1,572	1,666	1,527	1,469	1,488	1,431	1,461	1%	(5%)	2%
<i>Payments and Liquidity</i>	1,094	1,148	1,196	1,207	1,161	1,139	1,112	1,193	1,061	1,013	1,016	967	1,000	0%	(9%)	2%
<i>Securities Services</i>	141	131	138	140	141	153	156	161	151	158	166	159	160	5%	6%	4%
<i>Trade & Working Capital</i>	326	329	320	300	301	301	304	312	315	298	306	304	301	3%	1%	2%
Global Banking	411	447	447	400	472	488	475	500	548	548	588	543	534	7%	24%	10%
<i>Lending & Financial Solutions</i>	353	396	393	358	414	422	407	434	452	476	496	468	455	4%	22%	9%
<i>Capital Market & Advisory</i>	58	51	54	42	58	66	68	66	96	72	92	75	79	28%	35%	16%
Global Markets	922	877	716	534	1,041	796	840	773	1,183	1,172	848	938	929	(28%)	1%	(9%)
<i>Macro Trading</i>	786	776	595	463	884	631	683	654	978	961	678	751	763	(29%)	(1%)	(11%)
<i>Credit Trading</i>	121	116	122	92	167	165	174	138	222	187	206	191	176	10%	18%	17%
<i>Valuation & Other Adj</i>	15	(15)	(1)	(21)	(10)	0	(17)	(19)	(17)	24	(36)	(5)	(7)	(250%)	112%	414%
Wealth Solutions	511	495	526	412	616	618	694	562	777	742	890	798	764	20%	28%	16%
<i>Investment Products</i>	352	343	364	298	424	444	507	452	559	544	691	583	557	27%	36%	24%
<i>Bancassurance</i>	159	152	162	114	192	174	187	110	218	198	199	215	203	1%	6%	(2%)
Deposits & Mortgages	974	1,004	1,036	1,008	1,020	1,041	1,051	1,058	1,006	990	1,034	995	984	4%	(2%)	5%
CCPL & Other Unsecured Lending	275	264	270	259	260	270	281	270	257	282	277	284	278	(2%)	(1%)	(0%)
Ventures	17	72	35	32	32	48	43	60	42	278	39	49	59	(86%)	(9%)	(34%)
<i>Digital Banks</i>	14	21	27	26	29	33	39	41	42	46	49	49	51	7%	26%	(4%)
<i>SCV</i>	3	51	8	6	3	15	4	19	0	232	(10)	0	9	(104%)	(350%)	(211%)
Treasury & other	(275)	(212)	(281)	(268)	108	(48)	(52)	(55)	50	28	(17)	4	(28)	(161%)	(67%)	(39%)
Underlying Operating Income	4,396	4,555	4,403	4,024	5,152	4,806	4,904	4,834	5,390	5,509	5,147	5,041	4,981	(7%)	5%	3%

Source: Company data

Exhibit 3: GSe vs. company-compiled consensus

In US\$m	GSe			Consensus			GS vs consensus		
	2025E	2026E	2027E	2025E	2026E	2027E	2025E	2026E	2027E
NII	10,928	11,094	11,474	10,851	10,860	11,088	1%	2%	3%
Non int inc	9,971	10,269	11,081	9,783	10,221	10,981	2%	0%	1%
Revenue	20,899	21,363	22,555	20,634	21,081	22,069	1%	1%	2%
Opex total	-12,315	-12,426	-12,805	-12,169	-12,355	-12,674	1%	1%	1%
PPOP	8,584	8,937	9,750	8,465	8,725	9,396	1%	2%	4%
Loan imp.	-737	-851	-962	-862	-1,041	-1,109	-15%	-18%	-13%
Other imp.	-65	-144	-144	-65	-69	-68	0%	109%	112%
Associates	70	46	47	92	95	104	-24%	-51%	-55%
PBT - underlying	7,852	7,988	8,691	7,630	7,710	8,323	3%	4%	4%
PBT - reported	7,036	7,251	8,691	6,899	6,891	8,069	2%	5%	8%
Core EPS (US\$ cents)	226.8	234.4	269.9	214.7	229.4	268.2	6%	2%	1%
DPS (US\$ cents)	47.4	49.1	56.5	42.2	47.9	55.6	12%	3%	2%
Underlying ROTE	14.4%	13.6%	14.2%	13.1%	12.7%	13.5%	1.3%	0.9%	0.7%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: GS estimates old vs. new

\$ bn	Old			New			Change, %		
	2025E	2026E	2027E	2025E	2026E	2027E	2025E	2026E	2027E
STAN									
Revenue	20.8	21.3	22.5	20.9	21.4	22.6	0%	0%	0%
Opex	(13.0)	(13.2)	(12.8)	(13.1)	(13.2)	(12.8)	1%	(0%)	(0%)
LLP	(0.7)	(0.9)	(1.0)	(0.7)	(0.9)	(1.0)	(1%)	(1%)	(1%)
PBT	7.1	7.2	8.7	7.0	7.3	8.7	(1%)	0%	0%
Net income	4.584	4.369	5.333	4.652	4.612	5.634	1%	6%	6%
GS EPS	2.20	2.23	2.58	2.27	2.34	2.70	3%	5%	4%
CET1 ratio, %	14.1%	13.9%	14.0%	14.1%	14.1%	14.2%	-2 bps	13 bps	21 bps

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

STAN.L	12m Price Target: 1670p	Price: 1516p	Upside: 10.2%
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Neutral		GS Forecast			
		12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Market cap: £34.8bn / \$46.2bn	Net inc. (\$ mn) New	3,593.0	4,651.5	4,611.5	5,633.5
3m ADTV :£71.8mn/ \$96.5mn	Net inc. (\$ mn) Old	3,593.0	4,583.9	4,369.5	5,332.8
United Kingdom	EPS (\$ New)	1.58	2.27	2.34	2.70
Europe Banks	EPS (\$ Old)	1.58	2.20	2.23	2.58
	EPS growth (%)	22.7	43.2	3.4	15.1
M&A Rank: 3	P/E (X)	6.1	8.9	8.6	7.5
	P/B (X)	0.5	1.0	0.9	0.8
	Price/PPOP (X)	6.6	5.9	5.6	4.7
	Dividend yield (%)	3.8	2.4	2.4	2.8
		9/25	12/25E	3/26E	6/26E
	EPS (\$)	0.53	0.35	0.61	0.69

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 29 Oct 2025 close.

2888.HK		12m Price Target: HK\$168		Price: HK\$153		Upside: 9.8%	
Neutral		GS Forecast					
			12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E	
Market cap: HK\$350.8bn / \$45.2bn	Net inc. (\$ mn) New		3,593.0	4,651.5	4,611.5	5,633.5	
3m ADTV :HK\$164.0mn/ \$21.0mn	Net inc. (\$ mn) Old		3,593.0	4,583.9	4,369.5	5,332.8	
Hong Kong	EPS (HK\$) New		12.32	17.64	18.24	20.99	
Hong Kong Financials	EPS (HK\$) Old		12.32	17.09	17.38	20.10	
	EPS growth (%)		23.1	43.3	3.8	15.1	
M&A Rank: 3	P/E (X)		6.1	8.7	8.4	7.3	
	P/B (X)		0.5	1.0	0.9	0.8	
	Price/PPOP (X)		6.4	5.8	5.5	4.6	
	Dividend yield (%)		3.8	2.4	2.5	2.9	
			6/25	9/25	12/25E	-	
	EPS (HK\$)		5.88	4.11	2.72	-	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 28 Oct 2025 close.

Investment thesis — Standard Chartered (STAN.L/2888.HK)

Standard Chartered is a global bank with over 650 branches in 53 markets. STAN HK is the 3rd largest player, holding ~12%/11% of HK local market shares in deposits/loans. We are Neutral rated on STAN.L/2888.HK as **(1)** Valuation has caught up vs HSBC, **(2)** Structural hedge book is relatively low at the Group as central banks pursue rate cuts, and **(3)** Reported accounts look set to diverge more from underlying performance for the Group during FY25, owing to the 'Fit for Growth' programme, which is designed to reduce the cost run-rate over the medium term. We are ahead of company-compiled consensus on underlying PBT for FY25E-27E. Downside risks include reversal/pause of positive jaws delivery, weaker EM sovereign credit, slower non-interest income growth on tighter mainland China capital controls. Upside risks include higher-than-expected balance sheet growth; more hedges built to reduce interest rate sensitivity; continued strong momentum in affluent business; elevated FX volatility in the market; better-than-expected cost reduction.

Price Target Risks and Methodology — Standard Chartered (STAN.L)

We are Neutral-rated on STAN.L with a 12-m P/E-based target price of GBP 1,670, using an 8.5x target P/E multiple applied to a 25% / 75% blend of 2026 / 2027 EPS. Downside risks include reversal/pause of positive jaws delivery, weaker EM sovereign credit, slower non-interest income growth on tighter mainland China capital controls. Upside risks include higher-than-expected balance sheet growth; more hedges built to reduce interest rate sensitivity; continued strong momentum in affluent business; elevated FX volatility in the market; better-than-expected cost reduction.

Price Target Risks and Methodology — Standard Chartered Bank (2888.HK)

We are Neutral-rated on STAN (2888.HK) with a 12-m RIM-derived target price of HK\$168. Downside risks include reversal/pause of positive jaws delivery, weaker EM

sovereign credit, slower non-interest income growth on tighter mainland China capital controls. Upside risks include higher-than-expected balance sheet growth; more hedges built to reduce interest rate sensitivity; continued strong momentum in affluent business; elevated FX volatility in the market; better-than-expected cost reduction.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Chris Hallam, Gurpreet Singh Sahi, CFA, Benjamin Caven-Roberts, Wing Huang and Sachin Nayar, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DA CF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

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Across our global coverage, we examine stocks using an M&A framework, considering both qualitative factors and quantitative factors (which may vary across sectors and regions) to incorporate the potential that certain companies could be acquired. We then assign a M&A rank as a means of scoring companies under our rated coverage from 1 to 3, with 1 representing high (30%-50%) probability of the company becoming an acquisition target, 2 representing medium (15%-30%) probability and 3 representing low (0%-15%) probability. For companies ranked 1 or 2, in line with our standard departmental guidelines we incorporate an M&A component into our target price. M&A rank of 3 is considered immaterial and therefore does not factor into our price target, and may or may not be discussed in research.

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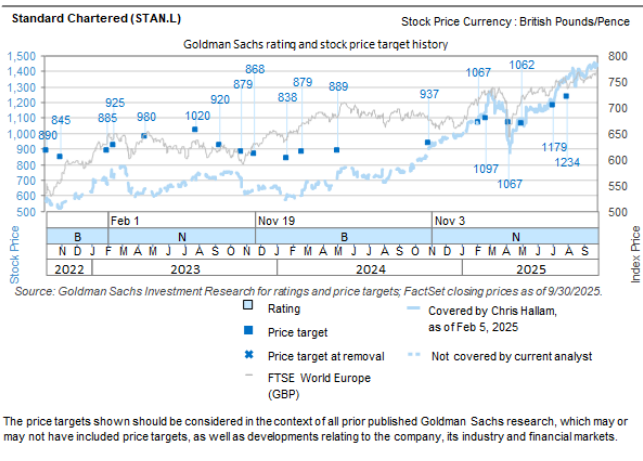
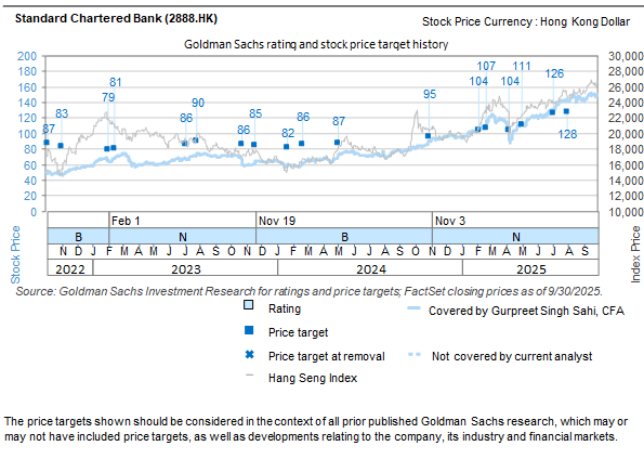
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Goldman Sachs Investment Research global Equity coverage universe

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Price target and rating history chart(s)



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